

RAM and storage, and utilised a stylus as a pointing device instead of a mouse. The original version of Windows CE was designed for a short-lived range of miniature PC-like devices called Handheld PCs. These devices looked like mini-laptop computers, but were awkwardly sized – too big to fit in a pocket and too small to use comfortably.

Windows CE and the first awkward handheld PCs also had the misfortune of shipping in the same year as Palm's innovative Pilot. This tiny, palm-sized PDA (personal digital assistant) was an instant smash hit, offering users a device that was pocket sized, useful and fun. Struggling to keep up with Palm in the suddenly-hot PDA market, Microsoft melded its Windows CE system to work on a palm-sized device and with the resulting loss of onscreen real estate. Unfortunately, it decided to brand this new product as the Palm PC, prompting Palm to sue for trademark infringement. After some grandstanding, Microsoft backed down, renamed the product to Palm-Sized PC, and held its collective breath. Palm didn't sue again, but then it didn't need to. The Palm-Sized PC was a dud, and consumers didn't respond to the devices that used a desktop Windows interface (this time with the Start button moved to the top of the screen) on a device that could actually fit in your hand.

Microsoft kept trying. It renamed the system, yet again, to Pocket PC and over the course of a few years, the software giant actually did pretty well given the relatively small size of the PDA market. But the most important change to come during the Pocket PC era was the development of a version of this OS that would work on a new generation of PDAs with phone functionality. Over time, these devices became known as smartphones for what we assume are obvious reasons. And Microsoft was uniquely positioned to enter and perhaps even dominate this then-nascent market. Microsoft's first smartphones were developed as an adjunct to the Pocket PC line, where one version of the OS would serve the PDA platform and the other would serve CE devices.

Windows Mobile

PDA phones began adding phone-specific features such as a numeric keyboard, dialer and contacts integration. In 2003, the software giant renamed this product line, again, this time to Windows Mobile, and it released a



Windows Mobile OS